Mrs. & Mrs. Gray

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Mature

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra)

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by ResFlower

Summary

"So, well walk through some of the stuf f the team found but I have something better. This is your next assignment."Glimmer pushes the folder in front of her. "It's the bitch that fucked up our last assignment. That firm has been going after too many of our targets so it's time to take out the competition."

Thank god, something productive to do and somewhere to channel her frustration with the whole mission. Adora opens the folder and stares. And stares. She then looks up at her friend and glares at her. "That's not funny , Glimmer."

She shoots Adora a confused glance. "What's not funny"?

She puts her finger on the huge printout on the front page. "That's~~T~~hat's my wife!"It could be no other but Catra looking up at her, stone-cold serious in all black, looking how Adora's never seen her before.

Glimmer purses her lip. "Cute, Adora."She rolls her eyes. "That's not your wife, that's the competition. W e need to take her out. She's not good for business."

OR

Adora, an assassin, finds out she's been married to another assassin for seven years. Oh, and they have to take each other out. Mr. & Mrs. Smith AU.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

When Adora goes into the office, she's already in an awful mood. She's one of the best in her field with over fifty kills under her belt. She's never had any issues with the target until last week. That asshole ~~s~~some assassin from another firm, no doubt ~~t~~totally cut of f her view and the target escaped. She tried to catch up but it was too late. Now, the target was in high-security lockdown and the chances of killing him are slim to none.

Glimmer had told her to take a few days to cool off so the team could investigate what went wrong with their approach. She'd grabbed some coffee for herself from downstairs so she got one for Glimmer too. She smiles gratefully as she takes a sip of the proffered drink. "Y ou holding up?"

"Y eah, still pissed though. I almost had him."She complains as she plops down in her seat. "Morning."

"Morning."She tosses it back as she goes through her papers. "So, well walk through some of the stuf f the team found but I have something better. This is your next assignment."Glimmer pushes the folder in front of her. "It's the bitch that fucked up our last assignment. That firm has been going after too many of our targets so it's time to take out the competition."

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Adora stands up in her agitation, pacing the room. "Glimmer, this isn't a joke."

She stares for a few moments until she can tell Adora is serious. Her eyes widen almost comically. "Wait, really? *That's* your wife?" Her eyes dart to the picture.

"Yes! That's Catra!" She'd know her face anywhere. Catra isn't an assassin—she works for some tech company where she does a load of things Adora barely understands. There's no way she's hidden this from Adora.

"No way." Glimmer takes a closer look. "She's really hot." Her eyes narrow on Adora. "You *sure* that's your wife?"

"Yes!" Adora hisses, her hand coming down to strike the table. "You've never seen my wife. Why wouldn't she be hot?" She asks, momentarily sidetracked.

"Well, if she was this hot I'd have questions. You know no one is this hot without some skeletons in their closet. Which apparently, might also be a hired gun." Glimmer eyes Adora warily. "Besides you kind of just complain about her. Or. I kind of imagined her I don't know...frumpy?"

Guilt tugs at her gut. She *does* love Catra, even if things have been difficult for a long time. Adora married her because she loved Catra and she was also great in bed and a good cover. Still, seven years of marriage have worn on them, and the spark they used to have seemed lost. Still, that didn't mean her wife had a whole secret life.

Adora shakes the thoughts out of her head. "Whatever. The point is, what I'm I supposed to do? I've been sleeping next to an assassin for the better part of a decade?"

I mean, isn't she sleeping next to an assassin every night?"

"Yeah, but it's not the same Glimmer." Adora lowers her voice. "I won't kill her. I can't. She's everything to me, even if we're in a rut." Catra floated the idea of marriage counseling just last week. It seemed like they might have bigger problems than that now.

"The hit has been issued though." Glimmer points out the obvious. Adora has never refused a hit it's not something that goes well in this industry.

"Just give me some time? Please?" Glimmer is her co-worker but she's also her closest friend. You don't get far in this industry without someone to count on and for Adora, that's Glimmer.

Glimmer sighs and bites her lip. "Just hang low and let's see if I can work something up with the team. Maybe there's an error." She allows. "You relax and try to figure out if your babe of a wife kills people for money."

Adora's eyes narrow. "Hey, she might be a hired gun but that doesn't mean you can talk about her like that."

Her friend gives her a saccharine smile. "Oh, that was purely because she's hot. See you later Dr!"

Adora shakes her head and rolls her eyes. "Thanks, Glimmer." She heads to her office. It looks like it's going to be another paperwork day while she stews over this.

When Adora goes home that night she feels like she's walking on eggshells. She remembers to take off her shoes at the door and put on the slippers Catra always lays out for her. Adora takes a deep breath, unsure how she's going to act normal. When she goes into the kitchen, there's Catra. Like always, she's cooking, putting the finishing touches on something that smells amazing. Adora leans against the entryway, staring at her.

She's always been beautiful, that was never a question in Adora's mind from the first time she saw her when she was on a mission in the northern reach. Today, she's wearing a baby blue dress that hugs her figure, and a white apron that is pristinely clean. Catra is clean and loves order, is a tremendous cook, and has a dry, if subdued, sense of humor. She knows her wife pretty well, she thinks. Could she really be hiding something so big from her?

Catra finally catches her staring and sends her a soft smile. "Hey, you. Dinner is almost ready." She walks up to Adora pressing a perfunctory kiss to her lips like she does every day that she comes home.

"Hey. It smells great." She pulls Catra close and her wife lets out a surprised yelp, not expecting the affection.

She looks down into Catras eyes, one hazel and one blue. Except in the picture she received at work, she was wearing a contact to make both her eyes blue. But it's the same face. It has to be her. She pulls Catra in for a hug, feeling her pressed in her arms. Catra hesitantly returns it, one hand rubbing up and down her back.

"Are you alright, baby?" She sounds genuinely concerned and Adora wonders if that's real or if it's a lie too. Catra is studying her face a little too intently.

Adora's been lying just as long and as well. "I'm fine. Just stress at work. You know how it is." She shrugs, one of her hands squeezing Catra's waist.

Catra laughs her off. "Yeah, I know how that can be. Although I think your job is a little more difficult than mine." If she weren't looking for it, Adora might miss the sardonic twitch of Catra's lips. She spins around and starts tending to the food again, this time serving plates.

"Do you need help with anything?" She offers.

Catra shakes her head, already moving things to the table. "No, I'm good. Just sit down so we can eat."

The table is artfully done, all of the cutlery just so. The handle of the knife is cold to Adora's touch as she picks it up, holding it a little tighter than usual. She cuts into her steak like butter. Have their knives always been this sharp? Adora has never noticed before.

"We need to replace that curtain." Catra reminds her as she works on her own food, her eyes glancing up at the big bay windows in the living room. She's sitting at the far end of the dining table, miles of distance between them.

Adora couldn't give three shits about the curtains. "Sure." She agrees readily.

Catra narrows her eyes, which in Adora's experience, can only mean trouble. "I asked you to look at the options I picked three days ago."

The only sound is cutlery touching the plates as Adora studies her face. "I looked at them." She lies. "I liked the second one." That seems inoffensive enough.

"What color was it?" She challenges, eyes bright.

Adora stops moving her fork in her mashed potatoes. "What?"

She leans forward in her chair, propping her elbow on the table. "What. Color. Was it. Adora."

Adora considers her for a moment. Catra never really angers with her~~-~~but maybe she does. Maybe Adora knows nothing about her after all. "Blue." She tosses out.

A look of clear irritation passes her face but then it's gone, shuttering away. "You must mean the green. I'll order it tonight."

She's sawing at her steak now. "Sounds *lovely*."

Catra turns back to her food and Adora does the same. It feels like a thick fog of tension has rolled over them~~.~~every time their eyes catch they dart away, minding their food and their wine glasses.

A thought strikes Adora as she takes in the careful way that Catra regards her. If Catra's cover is blown then so is Adora's probably . But there's no way to be sure. At least, it's not something Adora will discover over dinner conversation.

She walks to the middle of the table, picking up the bottle of wine that's there. Adora quietly pads over to Catra. The brunette looks at her, a tightness in her eyes that hadn't really left since they started dinner. Just as she reaches Catra, she stops, pouring her glass full of wine.

Adora doesn't bother to look at the glass, instead staring at the brunette. She gives Adora an even stare back, leaning back and gripping the arms of her chair.

"Thank you."She murmurs quietly as Adora finishes.

Adora doesn't bother responding instead letting go of the bottle suddenly. In a flash, Catra's arm springs forward, catching the bottle before it hits the ground. If Adora thought things were tense before, it doesn't even begin to compare to now . She can feel the realization sink in her gut~~.~~it's Catra. Her wife, the hired gun that fucked up her last assignment, her next target~~.~~all of it is Catra.

"Lucky catch,"Adora says, even though they both know it's not true.

Catra drops the bottle as if it burned her, red wine staining the white rug.

"Clumsy me."She gets out of her seat. "I need something in the kitchen to clean this up."Catra turns quickly , her steps measured but fast as she walks away.

Adora walks toward her office just as quickly. She can just tell that there's no going back and Catra is a hostile threat the same way she was on the tarmac last week. She finds one of her guns hidden in the drawer, drawing it and holding it out in front of her. Adora will be damned if she lets Catra kill her.

As she creeps along the wall slipping out of her office, Adora thinks she must be losing her mind. But there was no feigning the knowledge in Catra's eyes, the caught look when she used cat-like reflexes Adora didn't even know she had.

"Honey?" Adora calls out loudly, hoping to catch Catra unaware. She hears the rev of the engine and curses when she sees Catra's car pelting out of their driveway.

"Fuck!" Adora runs after her, knowing that her only chance is to cut through backyards and hope she catches up to her. There's no way she can start up her car in time. After a split second, she's running full tilt out of the house, gun in hand. She prays the neighbors don't see.

She cuts through one yard and catches sight of Catra's tail lights. "Catra!" She bellows out. "We need to talk about this!" It's ridiculous to think Adora will take the bounty on Catra's head~~the~~y just need to figure this out. They're married, for as much as it's worth now. Even if they lied to each other, Adora isn't going to murder her wife.

Catra's car keeps revving forward, and Adora makes the decision to cut through another yard. Her lungs burn as the cold air cuts through them. She grunts as she hops up, hitting her gut on the fence as she swings over. She's actually ahead of Catra's car now which is a relief.

As she pulls herself over the fence, her grip on the gun tightens and she feels the recoil as she accidentally pulls the trigger. She looks up at Catra's car pulled to a full stop, a hole in the windshield. It takes her a moment to realize her bullet put it there. Her heart clenches as she looks at Catra through the window, checking to see if she'd been

hurt. She isn't, but her eyes are tightened to near slits and her mouth drops open in outrage as she stares at the bullet hole.

Adora's stomach drops. "Fuck, fuck, fuck." This is going to be worse than the time she forgot Catra's mom's birthday .

She makes her way in front of the car slowly, hands up in surrender. "Baby , let's talk about all this." She gives her a tentative smile. Catra's expression doesn't change and she revs the engine. "Catra," Adora says sternly. "Y ou can't just run me"—

Getting hit by a car is worse than she anticipated, especially when Catra doesn't stop. Adora barely gets a grip on the roof of the car , holding on as the car careens forward. "Catra." She spits out but she's sure it gets lost in the wind. She bangs her hand on the windshield but it does no good either.

She hears the door open and snaps shut. By the time she turns to look back, Catra is rolling on the ground and Adora is still hanging off of the roof of her car. "Catra! This isn't how we're supposed to"—

Adora feels her body fly off the roof, and onto the ground with a thud that rattles her bones. She takes a deep breath and feels her vision blur. She tries to fight it but she loses consciousness on the hard ground.

Adora knocks quickly on Glimmer's door . There's nowhere else that's safe for her to go, especially in the middle of the night. She obviously can't go back home.

She's bleary-eyed when she answers but the moment Glimmer takes Adora in, her eyes are wide and she's on full alert. "What happened to you?"

"My wife." She walks in, her whole body aching. She'd woken up with what she assumes is a concussion and a searing headache. Not to mention a ton of twigs in her hair.

"You look like a car ran you over."

Adora lets out a harsh laugh. "It did."

She opens her door wider, gesturing for Adora to come in. "Oh. Yeah, sit down I'm going to get the first aid kit."

Adora stares into space as she hears Glimmer shuffling about. She knew it from the moment she saw the picture but it still feels impossible. "I can't believe she lied to me." Catra is always going on about honesty, about trying for their relationship. And yet, she was living a whole other life.

Glimmer scoffs as she tends to a cut on Adora's cheek. "Really? Not like you were the most honest person in that relationship."

"It's different!" She insists. "I married her because I loved her." Catra didn't want to talk and she ran Adora over with her car. The moment her cover was blown, it's like she didn't care at all.

Adora shakes her head. Her marriage hadn't always been like this. She remembers days when they first got together when they'd lay naked in bed all day, touching each other with gentleness and passion. Sure they married young and it was convenient for Adora—she needed a cover—but she loves Catra. Or at least, whoever she thought Catra to be.

"Look, you should get some rest. You're clearly upset." She advises. "And probably a shower before that."

"Upset? My wife wants to kill me Glimmer."

"You don't know that." She grabs a towel out of a utility closet and hands it to Adora.

Adora holds the towel tightly between her hands. "She ran me over with a car. How else do you interpret that?" She shakes her head. "Besides, if my firm issued her out as a target to me, I bet you

anything her firm did the same."They're stuck in a loop that'll probably only end with one of them dead or on the run.

"Maybe she's as confused as you are. V ulnerable. She probably didn't know about you either ."She reminds Adora as she shepherds her to the bathroom.

"W ell, she didn't seem very vulnerable."Adora hisses as her face stings from the ointment Glimmer roughly applies. "When she *hit me with her car*."

"Y ou seem really offended by the car thing."Adora balks and Glimmer holds a hand up. "Shower and sleep. I'm not dealing with this nonsense at two in the morning."

Adora and Glimmer search for Catra for two days and they can't find anything. Her office has moved and her car isn't there when Adora has driven by the house. Glimmer has been coordinating with the team at the firm, pulling on those resources too to try and find her. It takes Adora that amount of time to gather the courage to go back into their house.

She has her gun out and pointed to the ground as she walks in. Adora feels strangely emotional as she walks in, slowly passing by all the rooms they'd lived their lives together in. Something catches her eye~~the~~ curtains are dif ferent. It's the green that Catra had mentioned.

"Why would she come back and change the curtains?"Adora mutters under her breath. Another thought comes to her. "She'd already bought the stupid things before asking my opinion."It's so like Catra to just take over something like that, only asking for approval after the fact. Why even ask Adora what she thought? She practically decorated the house single-handedly anyway. Adora sets aside her annoyance as she gets to their bedroom.

At first, nothing looks truly out of place. Her eye catches something in the corner of the room. She peers inside the trash can and swallows a lump in her throat. With shaky hands she pulls out what she finds in it, hoping it's not what she thinks. Her gut drops. It's the videotape of their honeymoon, tossed away as if it were nothing. Catra had definitely been back to the house and with this, she's made a statement. Adora looks to Catra's side of the closet and there are clothes missing.

She opens one of Catra's drawers, finding a stack of her lingerie. Her eyes catch on a black one that Adora bought her to celebrate their fifth wedding anniversary. She remembers that night well~~they~~ hadn't fought at all, she and Catra spent the night together, laughing and kissing. She pulls out the soft nightie, something panging in her chest.

"She's not really your wife." She murmurs to herself.

Adora has to accept the fact that she doesn't know Catra. She's fighting for her life now and Catra is a stranger, not the woman she'd sworn her life to. If this upheaval has taught her something, it's that she can't trust anything that she thought about her marriage. Still, Adora is weak and she misses Catra. She's been missing Catra for a long time now. She pulls the soft fabric to her face, inhaling. It smells just like her. She shoves it back in the drawer and closes it.

She looks at the nightstand on this side of the bed and notices Catra's phone is there. She'd probably picked up a new one. Adora picks it up and looks through the recent calls, calling the last number. She holds her breath.

"Fright Zone Real Estate." Says a chipper voice on the line.

"Hi, there I'm calling from Horde Industries." She gives the name of Catra's supposed employer.

"Oh of course! How are you liking the new space?" The voice fills with recognition.

Adora smiles. She has a lead. "It's working out just fine." She lays back on her bed. "I have some furniture I need to ship, can you help me out with that?" Adora would find Catra one way or another .

It only takes Adora another day to be ready to confront Catra. Adora feels the elevator in the new Horde Industry building stand still suddenly and she knows she's been found by Catra. She expected as much when she got in the elevator.

A deep voice comes through the speaker on the elevator. "Seems like your elevator has stopped functioning, ma'am. Want me to send an engineer to see what the problem is?"

The voice isn't just deep, it's distorted. Adora grins. "No, I'm comfortable right here." She offers flippantly.

There's a pause. "Is that sarcasm?"

Adora finds the security camera in the corner and stares right at it. "I know it's you, Catra."

"You sure you're comfortable, Adora?" The voice that comes through is husky and teasing. Adora could imagine that they're in their room alone, instead of trapped in an elevator at Catra's mercy. She'd give anything to go back to a time like that.

"Why don't you come out here and face me? Preferably without a car windshield between us."

"No time for jokes, dear ." Adora leans her hands on the elevator walls, listening to Catra's voice. "This is your first and last warning, Adora. Get out of town."

She shakes her head slowly. "You know I'm not going anywhere."

"So you say . But you're dangling in a steel box with sixty stories of air beneath you."

Adora's eyebrows climb up her face. "Oh, is this a trap then?"

"You think I'd be dumb enough to leave my phone for you to find with a sensitive number on it? I thought you were more than just a pretty face, baby."

"Well, at least you still think it's pretty." She quips. As if she didn't suspect this was a trap from the start. "So what? You have a charge on the counterweight cable and two more on the brakes?" Adora lists off all of the explosives she disabled before she got into the elevator. The silence runs long and she knows Catra didn't expect that of her. "Whatever your plan is, it won't work because you always underestimate me."

"Oh, I do." Catra sounds amused.

"You have no idea what I'm capable of." Adora knows that's true, even if she doesn't think she could stomach seriously hurting Catra. Her wife always took over everything because she doesn't think Adora is able to do things.

"Likewise, baby. Did you check the base of the principal elevator cable?" Adora freezes—she hadn't seen that. Well, fuck. There is a sigh that blows out of the speaker. "First and last warning, Adora." She repeats again, this time more sternly. "Promise to leave town, or I'll blow it."

Adora lifts her hands up into the air. "Alright, I give up. Blow up the elevator." Despite all the evidence to the contrary, she refuses to believe Catra will actually kill her. Maybe she's a fool but she refuses to believe there isn't some truth to them being together.

"Excuse me?" Catra's voice is strained.

"Do it. Blow it up."

"Five...four..." Her voice trails off. "I'll do it." It's that stubborn tone she gets when they're fighting about which China set to put out for a

dinner party. She leans her head against the elevator wall for a moment, hiding her face. God, Adora misses her.

She looks back into the camera and shoots it a smile, imagining Catra on the other end. She wishes she could see her wife. "Come on now, Catra. All talk?"

"Any last words?" Catra's voice is smug over the telecom again.

"The new curtains are hideous." She can't help but get a dig in.

"Goodbye, Adora." There's an echo of her laugh in the curl of her words. The elevator that's rigged ~~the~~ elevator that Catra *thinks* Adora is in ~~goes~~ into a freefall.

Adora takes a deep breath as she hears the thunderous noise of the elevator she'd been pretending to be in crash into the first floor. Adora is about to unplug the cable she'd used to confuse the signals of the elevators, a deep disappointment in her bones. Catra really doesn't care.

Just before the connection dies, she hears Catra's panicked voice come through the line. "What the hell was that? I didn't—"

Adora pulls out the cable and stares at it, almost in wonder. It sounded like real fear, fear for her. Maybe not everything is lost after all.

Adora stays low for a few days but then it's Christmas Eve. Part of her realizes that Catra's panic could have been for a number of reasons ~~it~~ didn't mean she wouldn't have killed Adora. But the idea of her being alone on the holiday makes Adora's heart clench. Besides, she isn't planning on backing down and being on the run her whole life. When she finds out Catra made reservations at a familiar restaurant for the holiday, she buys a tailored suit and plans to surprise her there.

Adora is glad she catches sight of Catra before her wife sees her because it takes a moment for her to collect herself. She's in a dark slinky number with a neckline that shows off the slope of her collarbones. She's staring vacantly ahead, a single shimmering tear on her cheek. Almost angrily, she brushes it off and tilts back her champagne flute, demolishing the drink in one swig.

Catra has her hand on the bottle when Adora comes up right beside her. "You wouldn't be getting all mushy because you killed me, right?"

For a moment, Adora is worried Catra is going to bash her head in with the champagne bottle from the way her hand tightens on it. She can see the genuine surprise as her eyes rake over Adora.

"How ...?" Her voice is barely a whisper , more a sigh as she drinks Adora in.

Adora stuffs her hands in her suit pockets, shrugging. "Impressed?"

"Amazed." It doesn't even sound sarcastic and it makes Adora's traitorous heart beat faster.

"Amazed I'm still alive?" Adora makes her way to the chair across from Catra, sitting down.

She seems to get over her initial shock, jutting her chin up. "Amazed you managed to tie your tie on your own."

Adora bites her lip to keep in her smile. It was one of her favorite things when they got married. Catra would fuss over her tie, making sure it was perfect before pulling her close and giving her a sweet kiss. She can't remember when her wife stopped doing that. "Thanks, I'm full of surprises."

Catra is still eyeing Adora with something akin to hunger now. "That suit is certainly one of them."

"Thanks." She thinks of saying something about how fantastic Catra looks but thinks better of it.

Adora shifts the gun she brought out of her suit jacket and onto her lap. She can tell from the way Catra shifts her weight she has a weapon of choice in her lap as well.

"Hands on the table?" Catra suggests lightly. Adora nods, doing as Catra asks, watching for her hands to do the same. "How did you know where"—

"I proposed here on Christmas Eve seven years ago. I had a hunch you might be feeling sentimental." It was less of a hunch than a hope. Her heart jumped to her throat when she realized that Catra made a reservation here, on this night of all nights. She had to come.

Catra frowns, eyes guarded. "I came for the clams." She huffs, looking away.

Adora's eyes trail over her again. She looks so good, it feels impossible for one woman to be this beautiful. "Is that a new dress?"

Catra rolls her eyes in irritation at the small talk. "What do you want, Adora?" She cuts to the chase, one of the hands bunching on the white tablecloth.

Adora leans forward, careful to keep her hands visible. "We need to talk." It's been all she's wanted since this whole mess started.

"About what?"

Her eyebrows raise of their own accord. "Us."

She scoffs. "There is no us."

Adora feels anger at the denial. "So there's nothing between us, then?" How dare she just give up? If everything is up in smoke now, it only means there used to be a fire. She and Catra burned brightly, and she needs to know it was real, if only for her sanity.

Her wife stares coldly at her. "Only a table."

Adora stands up slowly, pocketing her gun. She walks around the edge of the table and holds her hand out for Catra. She stares at it uncomprehendingly until Adora nods to the dance floor.

"Really?" Adora nods and pulls her onto the dance floor. Catra rolls her eyes. "You don't dance." She informs her dryly.

Adora lifts her arms into a perfect frame and turns her face away, as the tango demands. She smirks when she hears Catra's sharp intake of breath. "All part of the cover." She says loftily.

Catra doesn't miss a step either, their bodies moving together in a way that's different than Adora's used to. She'll never get to tell Catra now, but Adora has always wanted to dance with her.

"Were the clothes on the bathroom floor every morning part of the cover too?" She grouses as Adora turns her. She takes a step too far, pressing Catra onto the wall, not hard enough to injure her but enough for her to realize Adora isn't fucking around.

She keeps moving, not letting Catra catch her breath as she reaches one hand under her dress, grabbing the outside of her thigh. She keeps reaching up until she finds what she's looking for, ignoring all of the soft skin there in favor of the dagger Catra is hiding. She throws it sharply, and it pierces the far wall with a dull thud.

Catra reaches behind Adora, grabbing her ass and then sliding her hands up to her waistband, pulling out the gun there, dropping it, and kicking it out of reach. They don't stop dancing and Adora ignores the way that Catras hips move although it's all she wants to think about.

"If I knew you could dance like this, maybe I wouldn't have thought you were so boring." It's sharp and angry, words meant to cut Adora.

Adora pulls her into a dip, keeping them there for a moment. "Who cares if I was boring? I was just a cover to you." She accuses openly.

She arches her brow, her foot grazing Adora's calf, almost making her lose her balance. "Who said you were just a cover?"

"Wasn't I?" She demands to know. How much of her marriage was even real?

Catra falters for a moment before she looks determined, a hired gun once again. "Excuse me." She says coldly heading up the stairs.

"There are no exits there." Adora points out, although she isn't sure why this would be a perfect opportunity to catch her and end this once and for all.

"I'll make one." She spits out before she keeps walking, sliding between people until she's out of Adora's reach.

She stares after Catra, digging her heels in to keep from chasing. She's a liar. Adora just needs to wait her out. She watches as a few people run and then there's an explosion upstairs. Fuck. She watches as streams of people run out of the restaurant, making it possible for Catra to hide in plain sight. Adora uses her height to look over most of the heads in the crowd, looking for familiar brown curls. She thinks she sees her and walks quickly, making it out of the restaurant.

She's looking around when she bumps into an old man. "Ma'am, you're ticking."

Adora freezes. Amongst the commotion, she hadn't heard the ticking coming from her suit jacket. She quickly strips it off throwing it into a mailbox a few feet away. "Get back!" She yells, waving her hand and running away from the bomb. It's a small explosion but if had been on her person it definitely wouldn't have done well. Adora shakes her head. "Catra." She curses. She'd lost sight of her.

Adora quickly finds her car and presses her foot on the gas pedal, getting onto the highway as fast as she can. For the first time since this whole mess started, she calls Catra.

"You tried to kill me." She accuses, hand tight on the steering wheel.

Catra laughs. "It was a little bomb, Adora. Lighten up." She sighs. "Why did you call me?"

"Why did you answer?" All of the noise on Catra's side of the line makes her think she's on the highway too. It gives her a direction, although she has no evidence of where Catra is actually going. "Never mind that. I want you to tell me something different. Tell me, what was the first thing you thought when you met me." The silence lingers, only the sound of traffic assuring Adora that Catra hasn't hung up. She has a knot in her throat. "Because I thought... the first time I saw you Catra, I thought that you were the most beautiful woman I'd ever seen in the day of my life." She can almost imagine her, dressed to the nines in that tiny bar. Her taunting smirk, first at the bar and then looking up at her from the hotel sheets.

"Why are you asking me that? Why are you telling me this?"

"I guess when you get to the end of something you think of the beginning." Adora can see the writing on the wall. This is going to end poorly no matter what and Catra's lost to her. "I just thought you should know the truth." She wants Catra to have at least that sliver of it. The suggestion that their relationship was real. At least, for Adora it was. "So. You going to tell me?"

"I thought you were the most beautiful cover I'd ever seen."

Her blood freezes in her veins. "So, it was all business from the beginning."

"Mhm. All business. Just cold, hard...math." Her voice cracks and all the background noise cuts off but when Adora looks down the call is still going. Catra muted herself.

"That's what I needed to know ."She hands up. Adora grabs the next exit and she can see Catra's car ahead of her . She speeds up, riding her bumper. Adora can't believe her wild guess is right and Catra went to their house. She smashes her car into Catra's as both of them hit the driveway.

Adora is all instinct as she pulls out of the car running as fast as she can and crawling over the hedge. She finds her toolshed, where she keeps her weapons cache, and opens the door. She's sure Catra is looking for wherever she has her stash. She quickly finds a silencer , putting it on the gun she had at the restaurant. She stuffs her waistband with another two guns and her pockets with ammunition. Adora also quickly puts in ear plugs.

She listens and she can't hear a damn thing outside. Adora quickly but quietly makes her way into the house. The front door is wide open so she uses the back. Chances are Catra is waiting for her to walk in blind and she's set up a trap for her there. Adora walks through the hallway, not finding Catra. She stops when she gets to the walkway that leads to the open area of the living room.

Adora knows she can't look around that corner without being a wide-open target. She looks around and grins when she finds something of use. She picks up a framed picture of her and Catra to try and see around the corner, using the reflective surface like a mirror. She catches a glimpse of Catra and she pulls it back. It looks like Catra is set up on the stairwell with some kind of shotgun.

She's unsure if Catra saw the movement of the frame, but Adora doesn't have to wonder for long. Multiple bullets spray through the wall, confirming what she already knew. She threw herself on the ground, cupping her ears against the loud sound of the shots.

"Fuck."She mutters under her breath but she can barely hear it over the ringing in her ears, even with the ear protection. Adora crawls as silently as she can down the hallway.

"You still alive, baby?" She hears Catra's voice ring out along with the heavy clunk of the magazine.

She's tempted to respond but then another thought occurs to her. Adora makes a half-choking sound and imitates a dull thump on the ground. Their house is filled with silence.

"Adora?" This time Catra sounds more concerned and she can hear her get closer.

Adora starts shooting immediately through one of the holes made by the shotgun, watching as Catra ducks and rolls out of the way running into the living room. She ducks herself as the bullets spray through the wall she is using for cover.

She quickly runs out of her first round of bullets and she hears a curse from the kitchen and she figures Catra did too. She takes a chance and runs into the kitchen at full tilt, taking Catra by surprise as she tackles her. Catra decks her across the face and pushes her again the wall, making her grunt in pain. She pushes back, using her height advantage to get out of the hold Catra has her in.

Catra is faster than her and manages to dart out of the kitchen. She can hear her reloading and Adora quickly does the same, heart beating loudly in her chest. She hides in the next room over standing stalk still to not give away her position. She slows her breathing, trying to think of where Catra might have gone. It'll likely be the bathroom or back out to the living room. The bathroom is too closed off but the living room is too open. Neither is ideal in this situation.

Adora turns and almost knocks down a vase. She manages to grab it, biting her lip and hoping that possibly that stupid thing wouldn't cost Adora her life. She recognizes it as one that Catra bought at a garage sale a few years back. The bullets start coming from the living room and Adora has to run again. She trips and ends up on her back, which is fine for the moment because Catra runs out of bullets again. Adora gets up and thinks to run past Catra in the living room to get back to the other hallway.

She only realizes her mistake when she's already entered the living room. Catra wasn't reloading at all, she'd just pulled out her handgun. She has it trained on Adora, taking a step closer until they are face to face, guns trained on each other.

She can see the absolute rage in Catra's eyes as she holds the gun up to Adora's chest and suddenly all the fight gives out in Adora. When she thinks of pulling the trigger this close, she feels nauseous. They've been fighting but she knows she can't kill Catra. She's always known that.

Adora lowers her gun slowly to Catra's disbelief. "I give up." She says simply.

Catra lets out a snarl, tamping her foot down. "No! Pick it back up, Adora." She demands, her own hands trembling on the gun. "Pick it up." She nudges the barrel of Adora's gun with her own.

She smiles sadly at her wife. She grabs the barrel of Catra's gun and presses it tightly over her chest. The metal feels cold against her, but it doesn't matter. It's the closest she'll ever get to a kiss from Catra ever again. "You want it? It's yours." Her heart has always been Catra's. If she wants to blow through it with a bullet, that's her right.

Catra's face crumples, tears shining in her eyes in what can only be an expression of heartbreak. It hurts more than any of the hits she's landed since they started fighting. Catra tosses her gun and it clatters on the ground. Suddenly, Catra is in her arms and she's on the receiving end of a bruising kiss.

The force of it makes Adora fall backward but by no means does it mean they stop. Catra kisses her with everything she has, and Adora can't help but respond, offering herself up in return. She's not sure if Catra loves her or wants to kill her, but she'd happily take this over what they'd been doing.

She lets her hands roam her wife, pulling her close and listening to the groan she releases and Adora manages to get a hand inside her

dress. "Fuck, Catra." She curses, her lips looking for purchase on her neck.

Catra tears through Adora's shirt. She's sure the buttons make some type of noise as they land around them but she can't hear past the ringing in her ears. She pulls out the earplugs but it isn't much better. She can't find any part of her that cares. She just wants to be with Catra. It won't be the first time she makes love to her wife with partial hearing and it probably won't be the last.

Adora turns so that she's on top, hiking Catra's thigh and hitching it to her hip. "Baby, please." She's sure she's almost yelling it but Catra probably can't hear well either. Adora isn't sure what she's begging for, whether for Catra to stop or to keep going. To love her or to just put her out of her misery.

Catra reaches out, her hands gentle for once, as she tilts Adora's face. Her blonde hair curtains both of them, like they're closed off from the world. "Adora. I love you." She has to read Catra's lips to make sure she's heard it right but it's worth everything. "I always have."

Adora can feel tears well up in her eyes. "I love you too. More than anything." She leans down and kisses her again.

She feels Catra widen her legs, making room for Adora's hand to creep higher on her thigh. She pulls off Catra's dress and when she's inside of her wife, when they both groan into each other's skin and are overcome with the emotions and physical sensations, it's like the night they met at the northern reach all over again.

It takes hours for Adora to sleepily open her eyes after Catra runs her ragged. Their house in ruin around them but with Catra lounging on her chest, all she feels is calm. She realizes Catra is also awake when she turns her head, catching Adora's gaze.

"I love you."

Catra's eyes soften further and she leans up, placing a soft kiss on her lips. "Me too, baby . Love you so much."

"Tell me something about you. Something real."Adora asks quietly , her fingertips running up and down Catra's arm.

"I suck at cooking."She says bluntly .

Adora can't help but gasp, looking down at Catra. "But all the dinners? You cook fantastic."Ever since they were married, Catra was always in charge of their kitchen.

She shakes her head, nuzzling further into Adora's chest. "The firm has them brought every day. It was part of my cover."

Adora looks at her wide-eyed. "My favorite casserole?"She whines in disbelief.

Catra laughs, tucking herself even closer to Adora's side, like she can sink into her skin. "Oh yeah, baby . That's all gone now ." A quiet settles around them as they think of the implications of that statement. If they don't kill each other they certainly don't have a way to complete either of their hit contracts. Adora knew she'd never complete hers but she'd never thought this far ahead.

"Fuck, Cat. What are we going to do?" They hadn't talked anything out and Adora has no clue what options they even have. "We have to get their traces off of us."

"Well, how do we do that when they want us both gone if we don't kill each other?"

Adora places a soft kiss on the top of Catra's head. "I'm not sure, but we can figure it out together."She can feel Catra tensing, worrying about the very real danger they're in. "Hey ."She tilts Catra's face placing a gently kiss on her forehead. "I love you."She says seriously. Adora is never going to stop saying it ever again.

Catra kisses her fully, leaning over the blonde. "I love you too. And Im sorry."Her hand gestures to the house that is falling apart. Almost as if on cue, one of the picture frames falls off the wall.

Adora shakes her head. "W e have insurance."She jokes, her arm snaking around her wifes waist.

Catra doesnt laugh. "No, Dr . We just tried to kill each other . Im sorry."She presses a kiss to Adoras cheek.

"W eve been through worse Im sure."Adora kisses her fully .

She raises an eyebrow. "W orse than this?"

"Remember that time I forgot our anniversary?"

"Oh yeah, that was *bad*."She leans forward and places a tender kiss on her cheek. "Fuck you, it was the fifth one too."

"I was concussed!I didnt know what day it was!Id spent three days in four different time zones too."Catra had let her have it for weeks and Adora had stayed silent unable to disclose any of the reasons why she forgot.

"No excuse. I still remembered our third anniversary after getting shot in the foot."

Adora pulls back to see if Catra is being serious. "How did I miss that?"

"It glanced of f my boot mostly."She gives Adora an impish grin.

Adora glares. "Drama queen."They settle back into each others arms. Adoras ass is numb from laying on the living room rug but shes not going to be the one to suggest they move. She probably has rug burn but it feels like a warm moment between them and she doesnt want it to end.

"I cant believe you can dance."Catra sighs wistfully .

Adora feels a pang of regret for all the dances that could have been if they'd been honest. "Sometimes when I'd see you dancing—I'd do anything to dance with you."

"You can dance with me now." She soothes, ignoring their predicament entirely.

"I'll dance with you whenever you want, baby." She hums to herself. "Oh! I was married once before." Adora adds to the pile of things she'd never disclosed before.

"Excuse me?" Catra turns and glares at Adora.

She shrugs. "It was a Vegas thing, wasn't important." She'd been young and they'd gotten a quick divorce—she honestly forgot at times she was married to anyone before Catra.

"What's her name and social security number?" Catra asks, eyes cold and calculating.

Adora shakes her head and laughs. "Absolutely not, you aren't killing her."

Catra buries her head in Adora's shoulder. "I could." She grumbles.

"You probably could but that isn't very nice." Adora tries to keep the laugh out of her voice but it's hard. The jealousy is silly and unnecessary but it warms her anyway.

"I don't have parents," Catra reveals.

"What? Who showed up to our wedding then?"

"Paid actors."

It's silly but her mind jumps to something else. "So I never forgot your mom's birthday." She points out.

"It was the principle of the matter , Adora." Catra sounds a little huf fy and Adora runs her fingers down her back to soothe her.

"Y eah, that's true." She concedes. As many lies as there are piled between them, she knows that there were other things wrong with their marriage too. It feels far away now, though. She's never felt closer to Catra. "Can I ask you something?"

"Of course. Anything."

"Why did you throw out the honeymoon video?" It's barely a whisper because she's afraid to ask it.

Catra winces. "Y ou noticed that?" Adora nods, biting her lip to keep from saying more. "I...when I realized that you'd had this other life, I felt so betrayed. I didn't think you loved me. I felt used." Catra starts haltingly. "The girls—Perfuma and Mermista, I work with them—they just started watching it when I came to pick up my stuf f. We looked so happy in it. And you looked at me like—" her voice is filled with tears "like you loved me."

"I do love you. Then and now ." Adora reminds gently , brushing a stray tear off of Catra's cheek.

"It didn't feel that way then. I couldn't bear to see it, so I tossed it. Tossed out the lie." She explains.

Adora nods. She understands it well—she'd had the same doubts and fears that Catra did. "Know this. Now and forever , it's you for me, okay? Y ou're my wife." She cups her jaw and brings their lips together.

Catra sighs when they part. "Okay ," She agrees.

Adora doesn't want to leave but they're probably in danger of getting shot at naked if they push this any longer. "From your firm, is there anyone you'd trust with your life?"

"Bow ," Catra says without hesitation. "He's like a brother to me."

"Okay . You get Bow, Im going to get Glimmer—she's the person I trust—and we are going to figure out how to get these contracts of f our backs." Adora sighs. "And then when we kill our enemies and we're safe, we can go to marriage counseling."

Catra lets out a soft gasp. "Y ou didn't want to go before."

"I was being an idiot before." There's nothing worse than losing Catra. Be it a hitman contract or insidious complacency, she isn't letting anything tear them apart.

"Is it bad if I think it's really sexy when you shoot things?"

Adora laughs and shakes her head. "No, because I think the same." She places a kiss on Catra's shoulder . "Let's see if we have any clothes without bullet holes and let's get our life back."

Catra smiles at her so tenderly, she thinks she would be okay with dying right then and there.

End Notes

Thanks to yagirlStatic for the name! This marks my 100th SPOP fic on AO3 and wow I can't believe that's the case. I'm always humbled and honored to be in such a bright wonderful community. Thank you all for letting me share my writing with y'all.

I have a 2000s movie love that makes me think that every film between like 2002 and 2007 should be a SPOP fic. It's really bad y'all. I hope you enjoyed this one though!

Kudos and comments make my bones strong, like milk. You can find me on Twitter and Tumblr.

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!